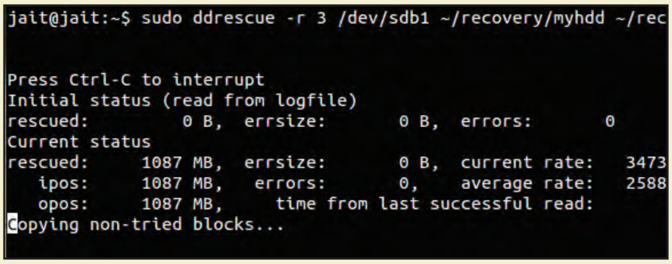
DATA RECOVERY

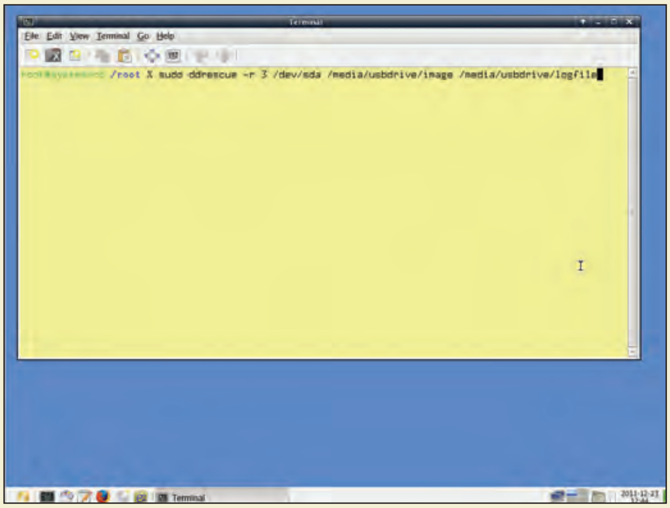
Imagine, all your photographs, the painstakingly compiled multimedia collection - music, videos and music, important files and documents gone in the blink of an eye. It's like your worst nightmare coming alive. The reason could be anything from a corrupt file system, a diabolical virus, carelessness or just a cosmic roll of dice. Though all is not lost, the data is recoverable because the information isn't immediately removed from the disk. If you're careful; then you can recover some or most of the data (depends on the severity of the reason that caused the data to go AWOL). Here are some tips on how to try and recover data from a damaged disk.

A word of caution

You should NOT write to afailed device, as it can worsen a hardware failure, and overwrite existent data in case of lost files. Shut down the affected machine as soon as possible. For recovering you can either use a LiveCD or LiveUSB in case you prefer to use Linux for data recovery. If you prefer Windows you'll have to remove the disk physically and attach to another computer and attempt to recover data.



Always to use ddrescue to create an image file and work on that image



System Rescue Disc home screen has nearly all the recovery programs needed

Make an image of the lost drive/partition

One thing that is a hallmark of data recovery is the excitement, you feel as if you're Sherlock Holmes, and all that is missing is a pipe. We'll start off buy making an image of the device/ drive and work on the image file for data recovery. Though this is not mandatory, if hardware failure is not the problem, you can recover data directly from the device. Despite this it is generally considered to be a good practice to first create an image the device and run recovery software on that image. Keep in mind that if the image size is greater than 4GB you'll not be able to use an FAT32 filesystem (usually found on USB drives)